

Psalms 111

Praise for the Works of the Lord

The works of the Lord are great, sought out of all them that have pleasure therein
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Praise ye the LORD. I will praise the LORD with my whole heart, in the assembly of the upright, and in the congregation.
- 2 The works of the LORD are great, sought out of all them that have pleasure therein.
- 3 His work is honourable and glorious: and his righteousness endureth for ever.
- 4 He hath made his wonderful works to be remembered: the LORD is gracious and full of compassion.
- 5 He hath given meat unto them that fear him: he will ever be mindful of his covenant.
- 6 He hath shewed his people the power of his works, that he may give them the heritage of the heathen.
- 7 The works of his hands are verity and judgment; all his commandments are sure.
- 8 They stand fast for ever and ever, and are done in truth and uprightness.
- 9 He sent redemption unto his people: he hath commanded his covenant for ever: holy and reverend is his name.
- 10 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom: a good understanding have all they that do his commandments: his praise endureth for ever.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 111 is an alphabetic acrostic—each of its short lines originally began with a successive letter of the Hebrew alphabet—and it is deliberately paired with Psalm 112, which mirrors the same structure to describe the man who fears the Lord. Henry treats the pairing as intentional: praise for God's own works and praise for the character His works produce in His people belong side by side, not in separate categories. MacArthur-style notes highlight verse 10's closing hinge—the fear of the Lord as the beginning of wisdom—as the point where admiring God's works turns into actually living in light of them.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The psalm opens with resolve to praise the Lord wholeheartedly, in the assembly of the upright and the congregation—praise as a public, communal act, not merely private sentiment. The reason given at once is God's works themselves: great, and deliberately sought out by everyone who takes pleasure in them, rewarding attention rather than remaining hidden.

Verse 3-4

God's work is called honourable and glorious, His righteousness enduring forever, and His wonderful works are said to be made memorable on purpose—built to be remembered, not merely experienced once and forgotten. His character is summarized in the same breath: gracious and full of compassion.

Verse 5-6

Specific evidence follows: He has given food to those who fear Him and remains ever mindful of His covenant, and He has shown His people the power of His works in order to give them the heritage of other nations—provision and possession both traced back to God's own initiative, not human achievement.

Verse 7-8

The works of God's hands are called verity and judgment, His commandments entirely sure, standing fast forever, done in truth and uprightness. Reliability is named as their defining quality—not merely impressive, but trustworthy across time.

Verse 9-10

Redemption sent to His people and an everlasting covenant are recalled, followed by the declaration that His name is holy and to be revered. The psalm closes with its hinge: the fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom, good understanding belongs to all who do His commandments, and His praise endures forever—admiration of God's works is meant to end in a life shaped by them.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

God's works are deliberately memorable and repeatedly rewarding to those who seek them out, and their defining quality across creation, provision, and covenant alike is reliability—truth and uprightness that stand fast regardless of circumstance. Genuinely

grasping this is meant to produce not just admiration but wisdom, since the fear of the Lord and obedience to His commandments are named as praise's natural, living conclusion.

Application for life today.

Take verse 2 as an actual instruction: deliberately seek out and study God's works—in Scripture, in creation, in your own history—rather than assuming familiarity is the same as attention. When you recall God's specific provision or faithfulness, let it lead somewhere, as verse 10 insists, toward wisdom and obedience rather than stopping at appreciation. Bring your praise into community, as verse 1 pictures, rather than keeping gratitude entirely private.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What specific work of God in your own life have you stopped actively 'seeking out' (v. 2), treating as old news rather than something still worth deliberate attention?

2. How does the psalm's insistence that God's works are 'done in truth and uprightness' (v. 8) speak to an area where you are tempted to doubt His reliability right now?

3. Verse 10 ties fearing the Lord directly to wisdom and obedience—where is your own admiration of God currently stopping short of actually shaping how you live?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).